

Dillon Brown

Project 02: Complete Product Prototype

Written Case Study

Part 1: Introduction

There comes a time in a person's life when they struggle with inspiration. For artists, they may be unable to find a subject for a new painting. For musicians, they may not have any new ideas for melodies. Many people often find themselves struggling with a lack of inspiration. I often find myself in this situation, having no inspiration to create something new or work on. As a musician and artist, trying to find inspiration to work can often be a tough task. And eventually people like me will reach a dead end trying to find inspiration.

I believe looking for a solution to aid the issues of lacking inspiration would be a significant help for people in creative fields like myself. Being able to have a tool to assist with inspiration would alleviate the task of having to find inspiration on their own. I believe without a proper way to find new inspiration; a person would end up never improving or advancing in their skill or status. Often people may find themselves creating the same things constantly; artists may draw similar illustrations, or musicians may find themselves writing similar songs. Having a proper way to gain inspiration from an outside source would be a great asset for anyone who struggles with inspiration.

Part 2: Research and Insights

One common solution for gaining inspiration is reading self-help guides. There are many guides tackling the issues of inspiration, articles, studies, literature; all are forms of assistance a person can follow to help with their inspiration. One common solution you may find is articles giving tips for inspiration in the form of lists and guides. Articles such as "10 tips to solve inspiration" or "Ways I found to solve my lack of inspiration". These articles are designed to be helpful to the broad audience. Most articles are written from the perspective of the author and for the general audience, giving tips on what the author finds helpful for themselves, and how the average reader can utilize their knowledge. While these tips can be helpful, they may not be suited or specialized enough for a specific person. These tips are designed to be accessible and for any type of reader. I believe inspiration is unique to everyone and requires a unique experience. Having something that caters to them and provides their own needs to find inspiration can be more impactful than simple guides created for mass consumption.

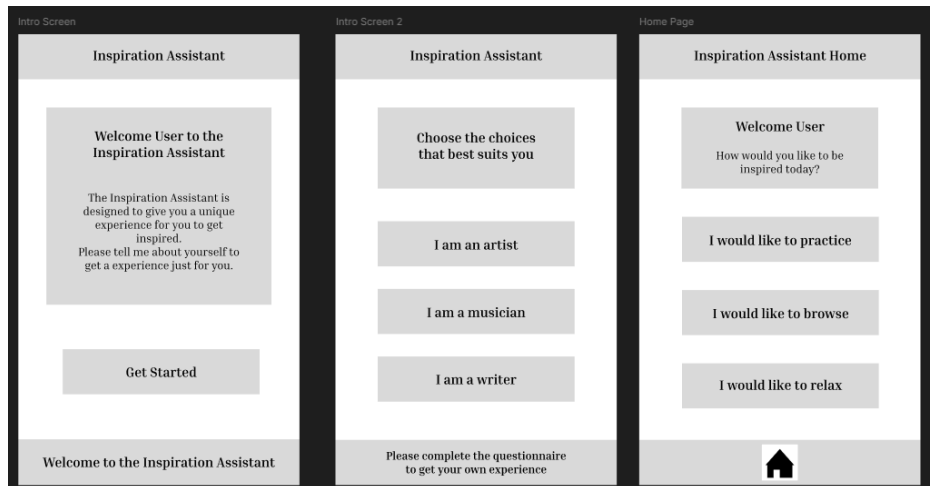
Even people who authored, starred, or were a part of a unique project can also find themselves struggling with inspiration. Often you find authors on hiatus due to running out of ideas or motivation for a series, musicians who take breaks from composing because they lack any melodies for a new piece. Anyone can eventually come to a point where they struggle with inspiration. From other people's experiences, their inspiration came from their own unique experiences. Many popular artists speak on how their inspiration comes from their own life and favorite subjects. An artist can find inspiration from their own favorite artists, and a musician can find inspiration from their favorite songs. The common piece from these examples is that these individuals find inspiration from their own experiences unique to themselves.

I believe that the common ailment to solving inspiration comes in the form of simple fixes created for easy reading, easy understanding, and easy execution. Creating something that is more curated to its reader would be something new and could be more impactful than a simple guide. A curated experience tailor made for the user could be a toll more useful than accessible styled guides. Being able to create your own experience and follow tips made specifically for yourself could have a greater impact on yourself than following guides from others.

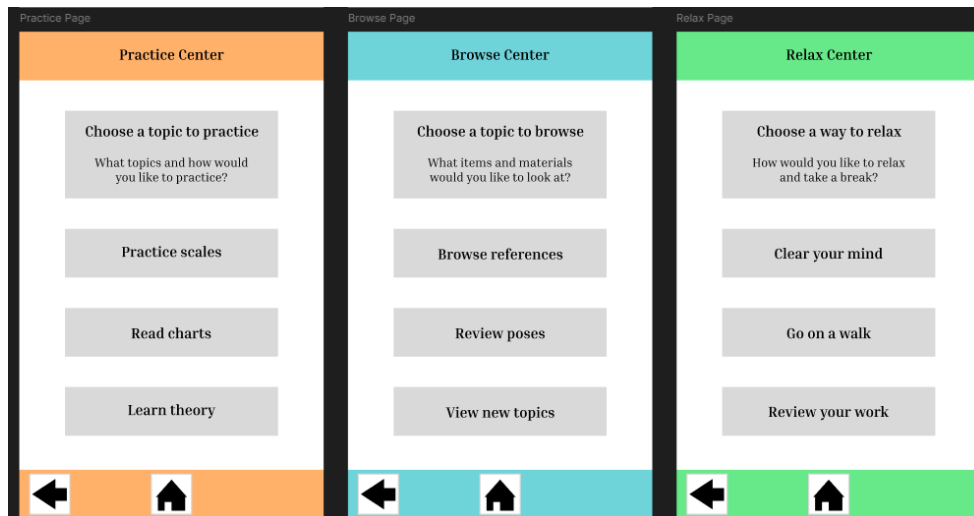
Most creative individuals can find themselves researching ways to assist with inspiration. And researching inspiration for this topic was like an experience I had before when I struggled with inspiration. I often found many articles detailing other people's experiences that I could relate to. Many sources stated how they found inspiration for themselves and how other people could apply their techniques to use themselves. I found inspiration in their works to add to my project. Allowing a person to apply their own experiences into the Inspiration Assistant can allow a person to find inspiration from their past to aid their future. Utilizing information such as their favorite works and pieces, what they are, who they are, what they enjoy, and other factoids about themselves can allow the assistant to provide material that could assist the user in finding inspiration from their own experiences.

Part 3: Concept and Development

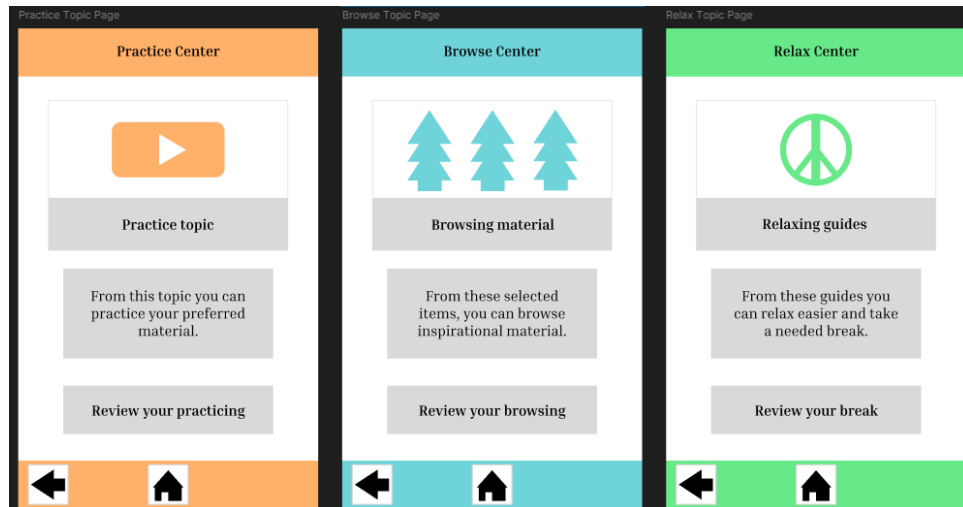
The Inspiration Assistance Tool is an assistance guide made to assist users struggling with inspiration. The tool was designed to be a helpful program to provide helpful instructions, programs, and guides to help those who wish to find new inspiration. The program is created to be custom tailored for its user, providing a unique experience for the user to gain their own inspiration with the help of the assistant. The tool utilizes information provided by the user to custom tailor their experience and help made just for the user.



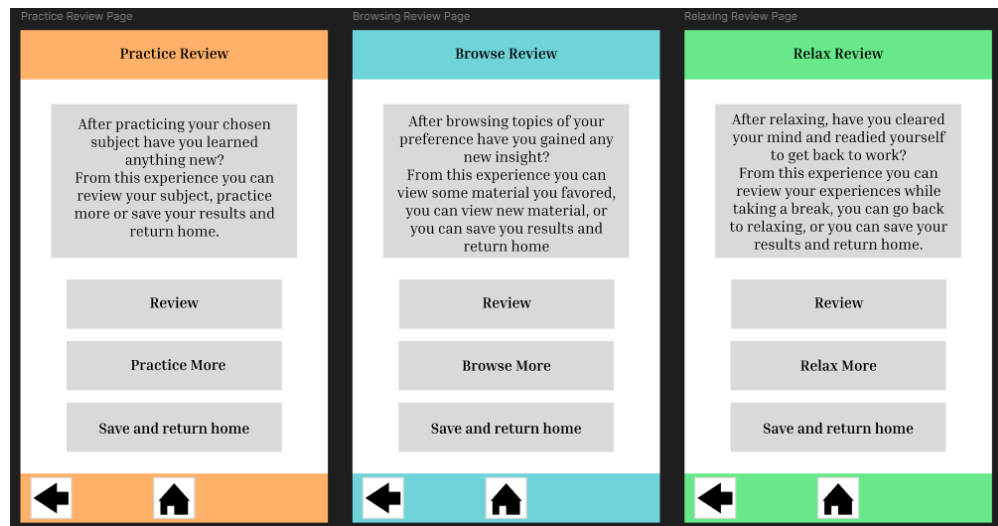
The user starts on the intro screen; the Assistant welcomes the user and prompts them to tell the user about themselves. The user answers the questions given to them by the Assistant and tells the tool helpful information about the user. After finishing the questionnaire, the user is sent to the home screen. The home screen gives the user curated activities that they can choose from. Each activity is custom picked for the user to fit the user's preferences.



The activity screen shows the user different options based on what activity the user has chosen. Each activity is unique to the questions answered in the initial questionnaire. The main categories of activities are practicing, browsing, and relaxing. The user can choose from the curated topics from the provided list and will be sent to the topic of their choice.



Shown are examples of topics that can be chosen from the user's preferences. Each topic is provided based on the choice made from the topics as well as the questionnaire. The topics provided are designed to assist the user in any struggles in inspiration they have. After finishing a topic, the user can review their experience.



The review screen is where the user can take a review of their current activity and topic. The user can choose to review their experience in their topic of choice. Return to the activities where they can choose a new topic. Or the user can save their results and choose a different activity.

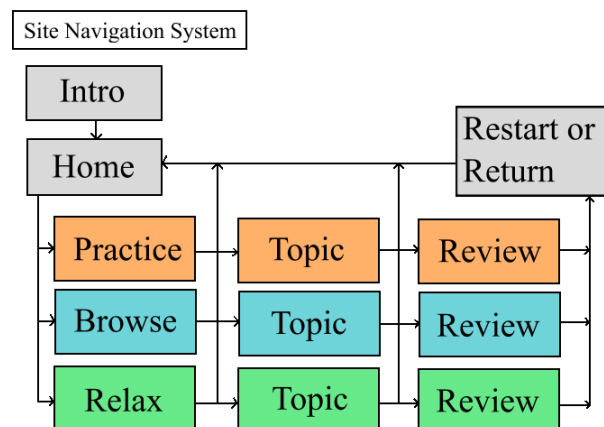
The core development of the Inspiration Assistant was to create a simple to follow, simple to understand concept. From the initial screen, the user can expect that their answers given will have an impact on their experience. While the prototype is simple, the core message can be understood that the user's preferences will influence what the user can expect to find in the future results.

The core archetype of the site is to follow a simple straight-line pattern. From activity to topic to review, the user follows an easy-to-understand path that takes them from point A to point B. Ensuring the site's simplicity was maintained requires specific design choices to be made when designing the site. Making the site minimalistic allows for the site to be simple to understand and aesthetically pleasing.

One core addition to the site was color-coding for each of the different activities. From feedback, being able to identify where the user was based on colors was a good addition. Being able to tell where the user is quickly based on context clues is an important feature of a site. Utilizing colors is an easy way for sites to allow a user to know where they are on the site.

Part 4: Design Decisions

One of the core design decisions for the inspiration assistant would be the site's navigation system. The core functionality of the site would be on a semi-linear pathway that is easy to follow and accessible for any skill level and tech literacy. The Inspiration Assistant is made to be utilized by anyone who requires the site to be understood by a user of any skill level. Having a simple to understand and easy to follow site navigation system would allow the user to follow through the site with ease.



The navigation style shown represents the core user's flow of how a user can expect to navigate the site. A user starts out at the start and easily flows through towards the finish and can restart. A simple to follow diagram that allows for a user to move throughout the site with ease. This design decision is made to accommodate any user of any skill level.

The design decision of making the site as accessible as possible is to ensure that any user can utilize the site to their fullest potential. The minimalistic design decision ensures that both user function and user form are both supported by any type of person. The simple to understand user layout of the site allows for easy reading, easy following, and easy use of the sites features.

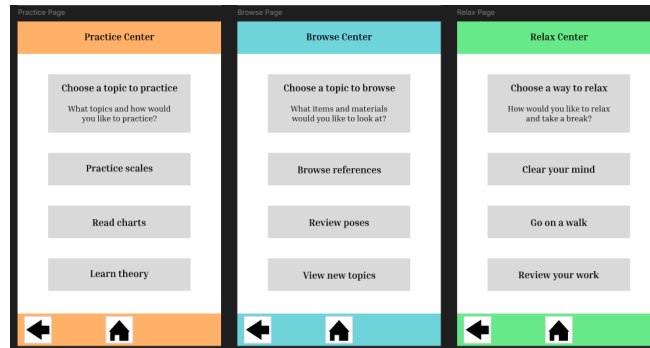
Accessibility is an important part of the site's design philosophy. Being a tool to be used by any type of person requires the site design to be usable for any type of person. While the minimalistic design may not be for everyone, it ensures that any type of person can use it. But from my own experience, having a good user interface is an important feature of a site, and in some cases, some minimalistic designed sites lack a good user interface.

The design of the site's user interface was a decision that was made and changed throughout the history of the site's creation. Minimalism can be seen as an easy task to apply to a site but can be just as difficult as a complex designed project. Ensuring that both the form and function are applied in balance is an important task when creating a minimalistic site. Adding too many options and buttons can overwhelm a user and ruin the sites' design. Adding too few options can hinder a user's ability to easily use the site's function. Including both design and utility was an important consideration when designing the site. Including the necessary user interface elements without cluttering, the screen was made with careful consideration. In the prototype of the site, each screen shows only the necessary information to the user without overwhelming them.

Part 5: Feedback

The main goal of user testing was to test the user's ability to navigate through out the site. Each tester was tasked with navigating through each of the site's options and paths. Each user was able to navigate through the site's different choices with relative ease, but some opinions were noted when navigating.

One experience both testers had was the problem of navigating backwards. The site hierarchy is a one-way style of approach, having choices being made and forcing the user to finish their path or using the home button to fully restart. Whether it was a miss-click, or the user's desire to choose a different path, both users experienced the difficulty of being unable to return to their previous choice or re-enter a new option.



A simple addition to better user interface elements led to a better navigation system. Utilizing a back button and a better user interface allows for easier navigation. Adding a back button to the navigation bar allows a user to now backtrack on their choices. The use of colored areas allows a user to understand where they are on the site. Shown above is an example of how the new system works. Each topic is color-coded to show where the user is and what topic they are on. And a back button as well as a home button is provided for navigation.

Part 6: Solution Analysis

The Inspiration Assistant caters to its user to find the inspiration most suitable to its user. Using information provided by the user, it finds unique responses, guides, activities, and material that would help the user. This solution works more effectively than other solutions as it is made for its user instead of a general reader. Other solutions are made using techniques and solutions written by an author for a general audience or a broad range of people. The Inspiration Assistant is targeted specifically to its users, providing material for its users.

I believe there is ample opportunity for a person to find inspiration in their life. But in many cases, they have issues finding it by themselves. Having outside help can be an important step for a person to try to find inspiration. Whether it is from self-help tips and guides, or through videos, a person requires help from others to aid their woes. I feel that the Inspiration Assistant can be of great assistance to those suffering from a lack of inspiration. Allowing for a more personalized experience made for themselves compared to other assistance. The Inspiration Assistant can provide inspiration that is unique to you and provided for you.

Part 7: Complete Prototype

Figma Prototype: <https://www.figma.com/design/5VtjnAXPnO7HJO4JkGLF/Brown---Inspiration-App---Project?node-id=0-1&t=8HuFLRW0IA1M5MUL-1>